

St. Margaret's Cemetery Annual Report 2019

TIRRA AGM March 19 2020

Please see attached treasurers report

There were 2 interments of cremated remains and 1 interment of remains in the cemetery in 2019.

One cremation plot was sold.

2019 was a busy year again in terms of the maintenance of the cemetery. In the spring an issue arose with Consumer Protection the government arm under which the cemetery operates. Confusion around the renewal of the cemetery license and the filing of financial records with Consumer Protection lead to several months of conversations, emails and submitting records only to discover (several grey hairs later) that St.Margarets is excluded from having to file these reports at all.

St.Margarets Cemetery wishes to thank TIRRA its executive and its members for the donation of \$2000 towards the continued maintenance and development of the cemetery. Our costs have escalated over the last few years because of the changing circumstances on the cemetery grounds. Since it is the job of the Board members as caretakers of the cemetery to be financially responsible for the long term care of the cemetery any aid is gratefully received.

Over the summer attention was given to making sure the willows were watered and would take hold on the restored bank, which they did. Our annual clean up focused mostly on keeping the blackberries from moving into the new cemetery area. This is going to be an ongoing problem. We have begun speaking with Capernwray about having the large mass of blackberries bordering the cemetery cut down and removed.

In October a work party was organized to take care of all the trees that had been cut the year before. It was decided that we would try to salvage as much as we could to make split rail fencing for the cemetery. Some of the logs were not suitable and ended up being bucked up for firewood which was donated to a family here on Thetis. We now have enough rails to fence the frontage of the cemetery. That will happen this spring after the new path is finished. Many thanks to the following gang who were remarkable in their efforts and knowledge: Tom Anderson, Bill Dickie, Gary Wickett, Arthur Gooding, James Alton, Keith Rush, Doug Fenton, Gurk Sarioglu. It was tremendously hard work.

About the new pathway into the cemetery:

Capernwray began the new entrance from their side early in Jan 2020. Work is still to be completed from their side and will likely occur when things dry up a bit more.

In February another work party was created and on that day the team of 12 wheel barrowed clay from neighbouring property to build up the new path through the

cemetery. Many many thanks to those who always turn up for this kind of work. It really makes my job much easier.

Gravel for the path will be delivered in late March. It will be ready soon. We are hoping to have an event to celebrate the opening. The large gate at the cemetery frontage needs repair and will be done this spring.

After the new path is opened, the fence is up and the gate repaired we will decommission the old path. It will be roughed up and in the fall of 2020 native plants and shrubs will be planted to re-naturalize that area. This will hopefully stabilize the bank more. We have been approached as a possible Riparian Restoration Project ,which will give us added expertise and support to make this happen.

The ditch performed well over the winter. With the massive rainstorm we had in early February there was some flooding into the cemetery where the water breached the swale but this should be under control now with the new path work done his spring. The rain garden pools did their job containing the water and allowing it to soak slowly down into the ground and /or directing it to the ditch area.

We will be “rocking the cemetery” all summer. That is we will be setting down rocks in the drainage ditch to make it more aesthetically pleasing and efficient. Watch for announcements on this.

St.Margarets Cemetery operates as a sub committee under TIRRA. We remain grateful for their support and for the continued support of the cemetery board.

Suzanne Sarioglu
Chair St.Margarets Cemetery

Addendum - August 26 2020 For Sept 12 AGM TIRRA

Since January there have been two interments in the cemetery.

License has been renewed and all financial issues resolved with Consumer Protection.

Application for changes to cemetery approved.

AGM held on August 18 2020, Board established: fee for plots will be increased by 30%; budget for re-naturalization and gates and fences determined.

Path is near completion and re-naturalization of old path to happen this fall.

Plan for opening celebration and family day at cemetery in June 2021.

Looking for backhoe excavator operator for .

ST. MARGARET'S CEMETERY

Thetis Island

BALANCE SHEET AS OF DECEMBER 31 2019

(With comparative figures for 2018)

	<u>2019</u>	<u>2018</u>
ASSETS		
Cash in bank account	\$10,248.00	\$7,095.00
CIBC Bonus Savings Account, including interest	\$15,172.00	\$15,165.00
Expenditures on addition to Cemetery land	\$3,409.00	\$3,409.00
	\$28,829.00	\$25,669.00
CAPITAL		
Amount at beginning of year	\$25,669.00	\$30,533.00
Excess of revenues over expenses for the year	\$3,160.00	-\$4,864.00
	\$28,829.00	\$25,669.00

St. Margaret's Cemetery is a registered charity for income tax purposes.

Simone Luckham, Treasurer St. Margaret's Cemetery Thetis Island